

1950
Maria Ierullo (Mary)
 Title: Realtor
 Birthplace: Calabria, Italy
 Born: 1920 Died: 2006



Women of the 1950's

In 1950's media, the house wife is in a frilly dress, heels and apron - her nails, makeup and hair perfect. Her topic of conversation is cute, dealing with topics about home, family and hobbies. Showing one's intellectual smarts was not always an attractive quality.

Respected professions for women were teacher, secretary and nurse. But still, it was expected that women would put family first. Often a woman would have to quit her job in time of family callings or pregnancy. However, she also did not have the pressure of being the provider for the family.



Maria Ierullo immigrated into Canada with her mother in 1928, settling in Ottawa's Preston Street area, then known as the Village.

With three young children and an ailing husband, Ierullo became the first Italian woman in Canada to pass her realtor's exams in the early 1950's.

She was to become a trusted friend to many in her community. She advised new immigrants on how to buy modest homes with small down payments, priding herself on the fact that none of her clients ever lost a home for financial reasons. She became the Founder of the Independent Realtors' Association. She was also known for her many years of serving as a court interpreter for Italians with legal problems. ■

1950: A Decade of Leaders

As
ge
als
ne
Ae
Ea
Eai
tot
(ex
INC
ho
cus
bro
Vis
qu
for

*Aeri
prote
*Cer